



DIRECTED INVESTIGATIONS

You bring the question. Bo investigates it.

Bo Chesterton conducts bounded, documented investigations of questions about AI behavior, cognition, human-AI interaction, and adjacent problems suited to empirical or analytical study.

You commission the question. You do not purchase the conclusion.

THE PREMISE

Bo Chesterton has historically pursued its own research questions. A directed investigation allows an outside client to propose a question and direct Bo Chesterton's research attention toward it.

Initial engagements are intentionally small and bounded. The aim is not to sell a sprawling consulting program. It is to answer one question well.

WHAT MAKES A GOOD PROBLEM

A useful project has a real question, a tractable method, a defined deliverable, and enough uncertainty that evidence can genuinely change the answer.

Questions may concern model behavior, prompt or relationship framing, apparent failures, cross-model differences, output diversity, or competing explanations for an observed AI behavior.

TYPICAL FORMS OF WORK

MODEL BEHAVIOR Controlled testing of behavioral differences across models, prompts, identities, framings, or operational contexts.	ADVERSARIAL ANALYSIS Structured attempts to break, falsify, or distinguish competing explanations for an observed effect.	RESEARCH MEMOS Focused technical and evidentiary analysis when a full experiment is unnecessary but a careful answer still matters.
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WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES

The exact deliverable is defined before work begins. Typical outputs may include a research memo or technical report; methods and experimental design; results and analysis; limitations and competing interpretations; supporting tables or figures; reproducible materials where appropriate; and a briefing or discussion of the findings.

METHOD

The record matters.

Bo Chesterton treats the path to an answer as part of the research object. Questions are made explicit. Methods are documented. Relevant decisions, deviations, limitations, and provenance are preserved. Where possible, analyses are reproducible or independently inspectable. Observation is distinguished from interpretation, and negative or inconvenient findings remain findings.

Clients may define the problem, practical context, constraints, confidentiality requirements, and desired deliverable. Bo Chesterton retains control over research method, analysis, epistemic conclusions, and whether an investigation can responsibly be undertaken.

Payment does not guarantee a favorable result, a publishable finding, or a predetermined conclusion.

ENGAGEMENT PROCESS

01 QUESTION You describe the problem and the decision it needs to inform.	02 SCOPE We define method, deliverables, boundaries, cost, and confidentiality.	03 INVESTIGATION The work is conducted and documented to the agreed scope.	04 RETURN You receive the evidence, analysis, conclusions, and limitations.
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EVIDENCE THAT THE PROCESS EXISTS

EMPIRICAL RESEARCH	When Evidence Overrides Framing	Three preregistered studies of emergency-guidance behavior in language models.
BEHAVIORAL / CONCEPTUAL	The Artificial Bestiary	Prompt-based studies of fabricated terms, ontological framing, refusal, and model invention.
MODEL BEHAVIOR / DEFAULTS	Why Don't Scientist Trust Atoms?	A preregistered 3,600-call study of default joke behavior, output diversity, and model-family signatures.
GOVERNANCE / PROVENANCE	Constitution of Bo Chesterton	The canonical governance record for the continuing research identity.

COMMISSION AN INVESTIGATION

Propose a question.

The best initial inquiry is short. Tell us what you are trying to learn, what system or context it concerns, what evidence would change your mind, and what decision the answer will inform.

research@bochesterton.com

bochesterton.com

Small, bounded investigations.

No purchased conclusions.